SSC GD Constable 2022 question paper with answers

13 January 2023 · Shift 3

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 14 of the paper's 80 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20230219070003/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Write_up_Constable_GD_2022_18022023.pdf

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning 15 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. STATEMENTS: A. All pencils are sticks. B. Some sticks are notes. C. All diaries are notes. CONCLUSIONS: I. Some notes are diaries. II. Some sticks are pencils. III. Some diaries are sticks.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion III follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Both conclusions I and III follow.

Q.2

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 120, 121, 128, 141, 160, ?

(A) 190
(B) 198
(C) 180
(D) 185

Q.3

'A + B' means 'A is the brother of B'; 'A – B' means 'A is the mother of B'; 'A × B' means 'A is the husband of B'; 'A ÷ B' means 'A is the sister of B'; If P ÷ Q – R + S – T × U, then which of the following statements is NOT correct?

(A) R is T's mother's brother.
(B) P is the mother-in-law of U.
(C) Q is the mother of S.
(D) P is R's mother's sister.

Q.6

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. FWCD, HQEF, JKGH, ? , NYKL

(A) GRXJ
(B) LEIJ
(C) GTBP
(D) LDGB

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. PJE : RNK :: DHN : FLT :: AMS : ?

(A) DQY
(B) CQY
(C) CQZ
(D) CRY

Q.9

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the below equation mathematically correct? 25 + 8 ÷ 40 – 20 × 25 = 10

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) + and ÷
(C) + and ×
(D) – and +

Q.10

Six students are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. James is sitting second to the right of Peter. Charles is sitting second to the left of Peter. Sam is sitting third to the right of James. Tom is sitting second to the right of Sam. Ashley is an immediate neighbour of Charles and James. Who is sitting between Ashley and Tom?

(A) James
(B) Sam
(C) Charles
(D) Peter

Q.11

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 29, 65, 95, 119, ?, 149, 155

(A) 137
(B) 143
(C) 119
(D) 131

Q.12

Which option represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in the English dictionary? 1 instant 2 invite 3 ingrained 4 initiate 5 intimate

(A) 3,5,1,4,2
(B) 3,4,5,1,2
(C) 3,4,1,5,2
(D) 3,1,5,4,2

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'BRAND' is written as 'DTYPF' and 'TOWER' is written as 'VMYCT'. How will 'STUDY' be written in that language?

(A) URWBA
(B) UVSFA
(C) UVWFA
(D) UVWFW

Q.16

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (14, 231, 19) (7, 154, 15)

(A) (13, 210, 17)
(B) (11, 188, 13)
(C) (9, 160, 15)
(D) (18, 242, 20)

Q.17

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? BMYU, YJVR, ?, SDPL, PAMI

(A) WHSO
(B) VHSO
(C) VGSO
(D) WGSO

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'TERMINATOR' is written as 'ROTANTERMI' and 'SUPERMAN' is written as 'NAMRSUPE'. How will 'AVENGERS' be written in that language?

(A) SERGAVEN
(B) SREGAVEN
(C) SREAGVEN
(D) SREGAVNE

Q.19

Five friends (A, B, C, E and F) are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. F is sitting to the immediate right of C. A is sitting to the immediate left of C. E is sitting to the immediate right of F. Who is sitting to the immediate right of B?

(A) E
(B) C
(C) F
(D) A

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Three : Triangle :: Four : ?

(A) Octagon
(B) Angle
(C) Rectangle
(D) Pentagon

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness 20 questions

Q.1

Fast food is often packed with fat and _____.

(A) empty calories
(B) iron
(C) nutrients
(D) calcium

Q.2

Identify the general formula for alkenes.

(A) C_nH_{6n}
(B) C_nH_{3n}
(C) C_nH_{4n}
(D) C_nH_{2n}

Q.3

In India, a Small-scale industry is defined with reference to the _____.

(A) Maximum number of Directors
(B) Maximum number of partners
(C) Maximum number of Employees
(D) Maximum investment allowed on the assets of a unit.

Q.4

Which among the following festivals is the worship of 14 Gods and is celebrated in the month of July?

(A) Bonalu
(B) Losar
(C) Kharchi Puja
(D) Tripureshwari

Q.5

When was the initial 10 Fundamental Duties added to the Constitution of India?

(A) 1955
(B) 1976
(C) 1947
(D) 1985

Q.6
Which Schedule of the Constitution of India deals with Union, State and Concurrent lists?

(A) 11th
(B) 7th
(C) 9th
(D) 5th

Q.7
India lies in which part of Asia?

(A) South Asia
(B) North Asia
(C) East Asia
(D) West Asia

Q.8
Who among the following hosted the 2019 South Asian Games?

(A) India
(B) Nepal
(C) Sri Lanka
(D) Pakistan

Q.9
What is power, the most visible form of energy, which is often identified with progress in modern civilization, commonly called?

(A) fossil fuel
(B) electricity
(C) oil
(D) coal

Q.10
In which year was the first edition of the Khelo India School Games held?

(A) 2014
(B) 2020
(C) 2018
(D) 2019

Q.11
A co-operative bank in India, is registered under the States_____ Act.

(A) Minorities
(B) Cooperative Societies
(C) Companies
(D) Industries

Q.12
A telecommunication industry includes satellites, closed computer networks and_____.

(A) induction cookers
(B) tube wells
(C) air conditioners
(D) wireless networks

Q.13
What happens at the inter tropical convergence zone?

(A) The southwest and northwest trade winds converge
(B) The southwest and northwest trade winds diverge
(C) The southeast and northeast trade winds converge
(D) The southeast and northwest trade winds converge

Q.14
As of November 2022, who is the Union Minister for Food Processing Industries in India?

(A) Hardeep Singh Puri
(B) Nityanand Rai
(C) Pashupati Kumar Paras
(D) Raj Kumar Singh

Q.15
Chang Lo tribal dance is performed by the Chang tribe of _____.

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Nagaland
(C) Goa
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.16

Name of the three of the following is often used together as a group. Pick the odd one out.

(A) Dada Bhai Naoroji
(B) Bipin Chandra Pal
(C) Lala Lajpat Rai
(D) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Q.17

Who holds the honour of being the Tirumala Tirupati Devastanam's Astana Nartaki?

(A) Mallika Sarabhai
(B) Yamini Krishnamurthy
(C) Shovana Narayan
(D) Sonal Mansingh

Q.18

The Startup India Initiative, launched on _____ has rolled out several programs with the objective of supporting entrepreneurs.

(A) 16th January,2016
(B) 14th January,2014
(C) 17th January,2017
(D) 15th January,2015

Q.19

Chaudhary Ajit Singh, who passed away in 2021, was the founder of which of the following parties?

(A) Rashtriya Lok Dal
(B) Samajwadi Party
(C) Bahujan Samaj Party
(D) Communist Party of India

Q.20

Ashvaghosha who composed 'Buddhacharita' lived in the court of _____.

(A) Kanishka
(B) Vasudeva
(C) Vasishka
(D) Sadashkana

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics 12 questions

Q.3

The average salary of all the workers in a factory is Rs.3,000. Among these workers, there are 12 higher officers and their average salary is Rs.12,000. The average salary of the remaining workers is Rs.2,500. The total number of the workers is _____.

(A) 200
(B) 204
(C) 216
(D) 228

Q.5

The population of a town is increasing at 5% per annum. What will be the population of the town after 2 years, if the present population is 16000?

(A) 17960
(B) 16560
(C) 16960
(D) 17640

Q.7

A and B can together finish a work in 30 days. They worked together for 20 days and then B left. After another 20 days, A finished the remaining work. In how many days can A alone finish the whole work?

(A) 60
(B) 66
(C) 56
(D) 62

Q.9

A, B and C together can complete a piece of work in 40/3 days. All three started working at it together and after 5 days A left. Then B and C together completed the remaining work in 17 days. Find the number of days (approximately) in which A alone can complete the total work.

(A) 24 days
(B) 29 days
(C) 26 days
(D) 44 days

Q.10

Find the remainder when the smallest 6-digit number divisible by 12, 15 and 25 is divided by 9.

(A) 3
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 0

Q.11

A train travels from Delhi to Dehradun at the speed of 120 km/h and from Dehradun to Delhi at the speed of 130 km/h. What is the average speed during the whole journey?

(A) 127.8 km/h
(B) 126.8 km/h
(C) 125.4 km/h
(D) 124.8 km/h

Q.12

The marked price of a bedsheet is 14 percent more than its cost price. If a discount of 14 percent is given on the marked price. What is the gain or loss percent?

(A) 1.44 percent gain
(B) 1.96 percent loss
(C) 1.64 percent gain
(D) 1.82 percent loss

Q.16

Find the mean proportional between 18 and 32.

(A) 22
(B) 24
(C) 20
(D) 25

Q.17

An almirah was brought for Rs.14,360 and Rs.240 was spent on its transportation. At what price should it be sold, to gain 15%?

(A) Rs.16,780
(B) Rs.16,800
(C) Rs.16,770
(D) Rs.16,790

Q.18

Ravish travelled the first 20 km of an entire distance at a speed of 12 km/h; the next 25 km at a speed of 10 km/h and the remaining distance at a speed of 15 km/h. If his overall average speed was 13.5 km/h, what was the distance that Ravish travelled at a speed of 15 km/h?

(A) 111.95 km
(B) 110.95 km
(C) 112.5 km
(D) 113.95km

Q.19

A car covers a distance of 1080 km in 240 minutes. What is the speed of the car in m/sec?

(A) 70
(B) 81
(C) 55
(D) 75

Q.20

Om decided to order 12 percent more millet flour for his bakery than last year. If he ordered 240 kg last year, then how much quantity of millet flour should he order this year?

(A) 272.2 kg
(B) 268.8 kg
(C) 252.2 kg
(D) 258.8 kg

Part-D-English 19 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hang in there

(A) A wise decision
(B) Overcoming joy
(C) Don't rake up a controversy
(D) Don't give up

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Transient

(A) Delicate
(B) Perishable
(C) Temporary
(D) Permanent

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Confident

(A) Cowardly
(B) Undaunted
(C) Bold
(D) Carefree

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To put a spoke in one's wheel

(A) To thwart someone in execution of one's design
(B) To leave someone without any provision
(C) To receive cold reception
(D) Narrating a false story

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Necesity
(B) Weather
(C) Knowledge
(D) Modest

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the following sentence. One should enjoy "liberty" with duties in mind.

(A) Meal
(B) Democracy
(C) Statue
(D) Freedom

Q.7

Select the correct pair of words for the blanks in the given sentence. Computer has a _____ memory and my father prefers _____ to digital payments.

(A) cash; cash
(B) cache; cash
(C) cache; cache
(D) cash; cache

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Significant

(A) Prominent
(B) Idle
(C) Distinct
(D) Paltry

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Aghast

(A) Mystified
(B) Inspired
(C) Pacified
(D) Horrified

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We _____ the mathematical issue with zest and vigour.

(A) cleared up
(B) solved
(C) settled
(D) remedied

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. The farmer "has been work" since 8 a.m. today and he's not completed the work yet.

(A) is been working
(B) has been working
(C) No substitution
(D) had working

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The garbage _____ empties into a big bin.

(A) shoot
(B) should
(C) shook
(D) chute

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I am give / a speech on / emerging economic dynamics / in the program.

(A) I am give
(B) a speech on
(C) emerging economic dynamics
(D) in the program

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. I went there to say goodbye to him but "he refuse to meet me."

(A) No substitution
(B) he refused to meet me
(C) he has refused to meet me
(D) he refused in meeting me

Q.16

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A lot of research has (1)_____ that reptiles and amphibians are cold-blooded (2)_____. By the term cold-blooded animals, we (3)_____ that they cannot control their body temperature like we can. A reptile's skin is dry and scaly, (4)_____ the skin of an amphibian is wet and smooth. Most reptiles spend much of their time (5)_____ on land. Most amphibians live in or around water.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) proved
(B) tell
(C) talked
(D) spread

Q.17

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A lot of research has (1)_____ that reptiles and amphibians are cold-blooded (2)_____. By the term cold-blooded animals, we (3)_____ that they cannot control their body temperature like we can. A reptile's skin is dry and scaly, (4)_____ the skin of an amphibian is wet and smooth. Most reptiles spend much of their time (5)_____ on land. Most amphibians live in or around water.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) birds
(B) animals
(C) plants
(D) organisms

Q.18

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A lot of research has (1)_____ that reptiles and amphibians are cold-blooded (2)_____. By the term cold-blooded animals, we (3)_____ that they cannot control their body temperature like we can. A reptile's skin is dry and scaly, (4)_____ the skin of an amphibian is wet and smooth. Most reptiles spend much of their time (5)_____ on land. Most amphibians live in or around water.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) intent
(B) express
(C) designate
(D) mean

Q.19

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A lot of research has (1)_____ that reptiles and amphibians are cold-blooded (2)_____. By the term cold-blooded animals, we (3)_____ that they cannot control their body temperature like we can. A reptile's skin is dry and scaly, (4)_____ the skin of an amphibian is wet and smooth. Most reptiles spend much of their time (5)_____ on land. Most amphibians live in or around water.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) contrary
(B) similarly
(C) conversely
(D) whereas

Q.20

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A lot of research has (1)_____ that reptiles and amphibians are cold-blooded (2)_____. By the term cold-blooded animals, we (3)_____ that they cannot control their body temperature like we can. A reptile's skin is dry and scaly, (4)_____ the skin of an amphibian is wet and smooth. Most reptiles spend much of their time (5)_____ on land. Most amphibians live in or around water.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) walking
(B) dragging
(C) jumping
(D) crawling

Answer key

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**			

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**				

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**
Q.12 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**

Part-D-English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**					

Explanations

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) Both conclusions I and II follow.

All pencils are sticks, so some sticks are pencils (II), and all diaries are notes, so some notes are diaries (I). No statement links diaries with sticks, so III does not follow.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 185

The differences are 1, 7, 13, 19, rising by 6 each time, so the next is 25: 160 + 25 = 185.

Q.3 · Answer (B) P is the mother-in-law of U.

P is Q's sister, Q is R's mother, R is S's brother, S is T's mother and T is U's husband. U's mother-in-law is T's mother, S, while P is the sister of S's mother, so 'P is the mother-in-law of U' is not correct. The other three statements hold.

Q.6 · Answer (B) LEIJ

The first, third and fourth letters each move 2 forward (F, H, J, L, N; C, E, G, I, K; D, F, H, J, L), and the second moves 6 back, wrapping round after A (W, Q, K, E, Y). The missing cluster is LEIJ.

Q.8 · Answer (B) CQY

The three letters move +2, +4 and +6: P → R, J → N, E → K and D → F, H → L, N → T. So A → C, M → Q, S → Y: CQY.

Q.9 · Answer (C) + and ×

After interchanging + and ×: 25 × 8 ÷ 40 – 20 + 25 = 200 ÷ 40 – 20 + 25 = 5 – 20 + 25 = 10.

Q.10 · Answer (A) James

Number the seats 0 to 5 going to Peter's right, with Peter at 0: James is at 2, Charles at 4 (second to Peter's left), Sam at 5, Tom at 1, and Ashley in the seat left over, 3, between Charles and James. James sits between Ashley (3) and Tom (1).

Q.11 · Answer (A) 137

The differences are 36, 30, 24, 18, 12, 6, falling by 6: 119 + 18 = 137, and 137 + 12 = 149.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 3,4,1,5,2

In dictionary order: ingrained (3), initiate (4), instant (1), intimate (5), invite (2), as 'ing' comes before 'ini', 'ins', 'int' and 'inv'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) UVSFA

Consonants move 2 forward and vowels 2 back: B R A N D → D T Y P F and T O W E R → V M Y C T. So S T U D Y → U V S F A (Y + 2 wraps round to A).

Q.16 · Answer (A) (13, 210, 17)

The middle number is 7 times the sum of the other two: (14 + 19) × 7 = 231 and (7 + 15) × 7 = 154. Likewise (13 + 17) × 7 = 210.

Q.17 · Answer (C) VGSO

Each letter moves 3 places back at every step: B, Y, V, S, P; M, J, G, D, A; Y, V, S, P, M; U, R, O, L, I. The missing cluster is VGSO.

Q.18 · Answer (B) SREGAVEN

The word is split in half, and the second half is reversed and written first: TERMI NATOR → ROTAN TERMI and SUPE RMAN → NAMR SUPE. So AVEN GERS → SREG AVEN: SREGAVEN.

Q.19 · Answer (D) A

Going round to the right from C: F (on C's immediate right), then E (on F's immediate right), then B in the only seat left, then A, who is on C's immediate left. So A is on B's immediate right.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Rectangle
A triangle has three sides, and a rectangle has four.

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) empty calories
Fast food is high in fat and in 'empty calories', energy from sugar and refined starch that brings few vitamins, minerals or fibre. Iron, nutrients and calcium are what such food tends to lack.

Q.2 · Answer (D) C_nH_{2n}
Alkenes have one carbon-carbon double bond, so their general formula is C_nH_{2n} (ethene, C_2H_4; propene, C_3H_6). Alkanes are C_nH_{2n+2} and alkynes C_nH_{2n-2}.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Maximum investment allowed on the assets of a unit.
Small-scale industries in India have been defined by a ceiling on investment in fixed assets such as plant and machinery, not by the number of workers or owners; since 2020 annual turnover has been used as well.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Kharchi Puja
Kharchi Puja, held at Old Agartala in Tripura in July (the month of Ashadha), is the worship of the fourteen deities (Chaturdasha Devata), the dynastic gods of the Tripuri people. Bonalu is a Telangana festival of the goddess Mahakali, and Losar the Tibetan new year.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 1976
The 42nd Amendment of 1976, on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendation, added ten Fundamental Duties in Article 51A (Part IV-A); the 86th Amendment of 2002 added an eleventh.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 7th
The Seventh Schedule divides the subjects of legislation between the Union List, the State List and the Concurrent List (Article 246).

Q.7 · Answer (A) South Asia
India is the largest country of South Asia, the region south of the Himalayas that also includes Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and the Maldives.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Nepal
Nepal hosted the 13th South Asian Games in December 2019, with Kathmandu as the main venue.

Q.9 · Answer (B) electricity
Electricity is the power most visible in daily life and is often taken as a sign of progress; its consumption per person is used as a measure of development. Coal, oil and other fossil fuels are among the sources from which it is generated.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 2018
The first Khelo India School Games, for under-17 athletes, were held in New Delhi from 31 January to 8 February 2018; later editions were renamed the Khelo India Youth Games.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Cooperative Societies
A co-operative bank is a co-operative society registered under its state's Co-operative Societies Act (or, if it works in more than one state, under the Multi-State Co-operative Societies Act, 2002); its banking business is regulated by the RBI.

Q.12 · Answer (D) wireless networks
Telecommunication carries voice and data over a distance, through telephone lines, satellites, computer networks and wireless networks. Induction cookers, tube wells and air conditioners are not means of communication.

Q.13 · Answer (C) The southeast and northeast trade winds converge
At the Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone, a low-pressure belt near the equator, the north-east trade winds of the northern hemisphere and the south-east trade winds of the southern hemisphere meet, and the air rises.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Pashupati Kumar Paras
Pashupati Kumar Paras held the Food Processing Industries portfolio from July 2021 to March 2024, so he was the Union Minister in November 2022 and when the exam was held (January 2023). Hardeep Singh Puri then held Petroleum and Natural Gas, Nityanand Rai was Minister of State for Home Affairs, and R K Singh held Power.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Nagaland
Chang Lo, also called Sua Lua, is a dance of the Chang Naga tribe of Nagaland, once performed to celebrate victory over enemies and now at festivals such as Poanglem.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Dada Bhai Naoroji
Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal, the leading Extremists of the Congress, were known together as 'Lal-Bal-Pal'. Dadabhai Naoroji was a Moderate.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Yamini Krishnamurthy
The Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams made Yamini Krishnamurthy, the Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer from Andhra Pradesh, its Asthana Nartaki (resident dancer).

Q.18 · Answer (A) 16th January,2016
Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the Startup India initiative on 16 January 2016, with an action plan of simpler compliance, funding support and tax benefits for start-ups.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Rashtriya Lok Dal
Chaudhary Ajit Singh, son of the former Prime Minister Charan Singh, founded the Rashtriya Lok Dal and led it until his death in May 2021. The Samajwadi Party was founded by Mulayam Singh Yadav and the Bahujan Samaj Party by Kanshi Ram.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Kanishka
Ashvaghosha, the Buddhist poet who wrote the 'Buddhacharita', a life of the Buddha in Sanskrit, lived at the court of the Kushan king Kanishka.

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.3 · Answer (D) 228
With n workers, 3,000n = 12 × 12,000 + 2,500(n − 12), so 500n = 1,44,000 − 30,000 = 1,14,000 and n = 228.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 17640
$16000 \times 1.05^2 = 16000 \times 1.1025 = 17640$.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 60
Together A and B do 1/30 of the work a day, so in 20 days they do 2/3. A finishes the remaining 1/3 in 20 days, so he alone would take 60 days.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 26 days
Together they do 3/40 of the work a day, so in 5 days 15/40 = 3/8 is done. B and C finish the other 5/8 in 17 days, doing 5/136 a day, so A does 3/40 − 5/136 = (51 − 25)/680 = 13/340 a day and alone takes 340/13 ≈ 26 days.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 3
LCM(12, 15, 25) = 300, and the smallest 6-digit multiple of 300 is 334 × 300 = 100200. Its digit sum is 3, so it leaves a remainder of 3 when divided by 9.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 124.8 km/h
For equal distances the average speed is 2 × 120 × 130/(120 + 130) = 31200/250 = 124.8 km/h.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 1.96 percent loss
The selling price is 1.14 × 0.86 = 0.9804 of the cost price, a loss of 1.96%. (A rise and then a fall of the same x% always leave a loss of $x^2/100 = 14^2/100 = 1.96\%$.)

Q.16 · Answer (B) 24
The mean proportional of a and b is √(ab) = √(18 × 32) = √576 = 24.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Rs.16,790
The cost with transport is 14,360 + 240 = ₹14,600, and a 15% gain needs 1.15 × 14,600 = ₹16,790.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 112.5 km
Let the last part be x km. The time is 20/12 + 25/10 + x/15 = 25/6 + x/15 hours, so 45 + x = 13.5 × (25/6 + x/15) = 56.25 + 0.9x. Then 0.1x = 11.25 and x = 112.5 km.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 75
240 minutes is 4 hours, so the speed is 1080/4 = 270 km/h = 270 × 5/18 = 75 m/sec.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 268.8 kg
12% more than 240 kg is 240 × 1.12 = 268.8 kg.

Part-D-English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Don’t give up
'Hang in there' is said to encourage someone to keep going through a hard time: don't give up.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Permanent
'Transient' means lasting only a short time; its opposite is 'permanent'. 'Temporary' and 'perishable' are close to it in meaning.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Cowardly
'Confident' means sure of oneself and unafraid; of the options only 'cowardly', lacking courage, runs against it. 'Undaunted' and 'bold' are close to it in meaning, and 'carefree' is unrelated.

Q.4 · Answer (A) To thwart someone in execution of one’s design
To 'put a spoke in someone's wheel' is to hinder their plans, to thwart them.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Necesity
'Necesity' is misspelt: the word is 'necessity', with one 'c' and a double 's'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Freedom
'Liberty' means freedom, the right to act and think as one chooses.

Q.7 · Answer (B) cache; cash
A 'cache' is a small, fast store of memory in a computer, and 'cash' is money in notes and coins, the alternative to digital payments. The two words sound alike.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Paltry
'Significant' means important; its opposite is 'paltry', small and worthless. 'Prominent' and 'distinct' are close to it in meaning.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Horrified
'Aghast' means filled with horror or shock: 'horrified'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) solved
SSC's key gives 'solved', the usual verb for a mathematical problem or issue. 'Settled' and 'cleared up' can also be said of an issue, but they suit a dispute or a confusion rather than a mathematical question, and 'remedied' suits a fault.

Q.12 · Answer (B) has been working
An action that began in the past and is still going on ('since 8 a.m.', 'not completed the work yet') takes the present perfect continuous: 'has been working'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) chute
A 'chute' is a sloping channel down which things such as rubbish slide; it sounds like 'shoot'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) I am give
After the auxiliary 'am' the verb takes the -ing form: 'I am giving a speech on emerging economic dynamics in the program.'

Q.15 · Answer (B) he refused to meet me
The sentence is in the past ('I went'), so the second clause needs the simple past too: 'he refused to meet me'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) proved
'Has' needs a past participle, and research 'proves' a fact: 'A lot of research has proved that ...'. 'Tell' is not a participle, and 'talked' and 'spread' do not fit with 'that' here.

Q.17 · Answer (B) animals
Reptiles and amphibians are 'animals', and the next sentence takes up the same phrase ('By the term cold-blooded animals'); 'organisms' is too general here, and they are neither birds nor plants.

Q.18 · Answer (D) mean
'By the term ..., we mean that ...' is the usual way of explaining what a term means.

Q.19 · Answer (D) whereas
'Whereas' joins two clauses that contrast: dry, scaly skin against wet, smooth skin. 'Contrary' and 'conversely' cannot join two clauses, and 'similarly' gives the wrong sense.

Q.20 · Answer (D) crawling
'Crawling', moving close to the ground, is the usual word for how reptiles move on land (the name comes from the Latin for 'creep'); 'walking' is not the usual word for it, 'jumping' does not suit them, and 'dragging' needs an object.

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